



harvesting or in spring, if their growth gets out of hand. Trim back any excess stems after harvesting. Careful pruning will encourage bushier growth.

## HARVESTING

Cranberries should be ready to harvest from early fall. They do not need to be picked immediately and can be left on the bush for several months.

## STORING

Fruits will keep longer than most other berries—up to three months in the refrigerator—and they can also be frozen or made into sauce.

## PESTS AND DISEASES

Cranberries are under threat from relatively few pests and diseases; if need be, construct netting to deter birds. You may find that they suffer from lime-induced chlorosis, caused by high levels of calcium in very alkaline soils, which prevents plants from absorbing iron—leaves will turn yellow and then brown, before withering. Acidify the soil or add iron to it to combat the problem. Practice good garden hygiene when pruning bushes, and try to encourage strong, open growth and a well-ventilated structure.